



Vivo X1 unveiled in China

The Vivo X1 was showcased in China, aiming to become the 'world's slimmest smartphone' at less than 6.65 mm in thickness

Windows 8 hits 20,000 apps

Following its goal of having 100,000 apps in 3 months after launch, Windows Marketplace hit 20,000 apps. 80k more to go

Google brings new security features to Android 4.2 Jelly Bean

The advent of Android 4.2 Jelly Bean brings new security features to the platform, features that have been required for a while to protect users from the many dangers associated with malicious apps. The new security features are built natively into Android 4.2 Jelly Bean, and the most vital of them, is in essence similar to the Bouncer feature rolled out for the Google Play store in February this year. While the Google Play store is now supposedly cleaner because of this feature, Android users are still at risk when sideloading apps from other sources.

Completely opt-in, the 'verify app' feature can be toggled from the 'Security' sec-

tion of Android 4.2 settings. Each time users download and sideload an app, it is sandboxed, with virtual walls put up between the app and other software on the device. A pop-up box will then ask the user if they want to check the app for potentially 'harmful behaviour.' The device will then send information about the device to Google's servers and compare it with a database of known applications.

Even if the app is not listed on the Google Play store, Google is confident it can detect if it is safe or not, as the company says it is constantly scanning the web for newly appearing APKs, and has a good understanding of how the ecosystem works. If the app under scrutiny is detected as safe, the installation will con-



tinue but if it is detected as dangerous, it will prevent you from installing it. If however, the app is questionably secure, but not strictly harmful, the user will have the option to continue with the installation.

According to Google, the app installation process will not be greatly slowed down by the new security process, as most of the processing happens on the company's servers and the user device only has to send an APK signature onward.

As for the other new security features, Google has also introduced an improved app permissions screen, for sideloaded apps, which is apparently much simpler to read than before. Android 4.2 also brings a scanning feature, that detects any attempt by an app to send a text message to a known fee-collecting short code (premium number) and will alert the user. The user will have the option to then allow, or deny the app from continuing with sending. 

iOS 6 fixes bug that let stolen iPhones read iMessages

Apple has finally fixed a bug that let the iMessages app receive messages even if the iPhone device had been remote wiped in case of theft.

Sources have confirmed to *The Next Web* that Apple has taken steps to correct the matter through a variety of checks placed on iMessage. The most important of these corrective measures is that Apple uses its push system to force users to re-enter the Apple ID password if any credentials of the Apple ID have been edited or changed.



So, if your phone is stolen, apart from remote wiping it, all users have to do is change their Apple ID password and messages will not be received on the stolen device. Transferring your SIM card to a new device or remote wiping it with Find My Phone didn't stop the stolen device from receiving messages in iOS 5 but thankfully, now that has changed for good.

Even though the bug has been fixed with iOS 6, what's surprising is that it took Apple a very long time to find a cure for this problem. 

Irish regulators ask Facebook to clarify changing privacy plans

Irish regulators have sought clarifications from Facebook over its plans to change its privacy policy.

Last month, Facebook proposed changes to its site governance and privacy policies, which included its data-use policy and statement of rights and responsibilities. Facebook also informed users it intended to abolish user votes on Facebook's practices.

Facebook says the changes if implemented would provide more detailed information about their data, along with

new features to help users manage their messages and reminders on what content is visible to other members of the social network.

The Irish privacy watchdog's deputy commissioner Gary Davis, however, said, "We will be seeking further clarification from Facebook Ireland and if we consider that the proposed changes require a specific consent from EU users, we will require Facebook to do this," according to Bloomberg Businessweek. 